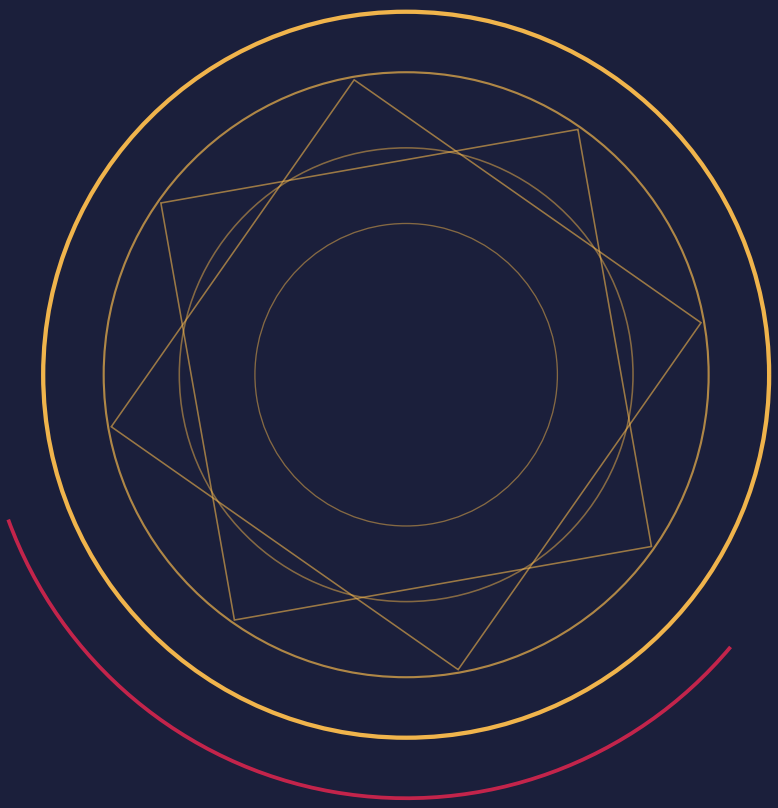


Frontend design brief

Three directions to mock up, then we pick one.

Summoning Circle team | Kiroween 2026 | week of 1 to 7 November

What this week is for

This week is frontend only. We design and build the look of Summoning Circle before any of the AI engine exists.

The plan is simple. Each direction in this brief gets a quick mock-up. We compare them side by side against the same scorecard, pick one, and spend the rest of the week turning it into real code. Nothing here is final until we pick; the directions are starting points, so push them, mix them or throw one out.

Why the frontend matters so much

Five things are judged, each worth 20%. The look of the product touches three of them directly:

Judging criterion	How the frontend helps
Design	Is it a complete, polished, intentional product rather than a tech demo?
Presentation	The video is judged on how clear and memorable it is. A striking summoning moment is our best shot.
Innovation	A fresh visual idea makes the whole project feel new, not just the code.
Impact	If people understand it in five seconds, they believe someone would use it.
Use of Kiro	Not the frontend's job, but the design rules we write become Kiro steering docs, which judges read.

The theme in one line

Mystic arts meets Halloween. Think of the sorcery in recent superhero films: glowing spell circles drawn in the air, reality bending, crimson chaos magic. Then root it in Halloween: summoning, spirits, possessed objects, the witching hour. Our product literally summons an AI into your browser, so the theme is not decoration; it explains what the product does.

What the theme has to do

- **Explain the product.** The summoning circle is the loading screen. When a model downloads, the ritual progresses. Real progress, never a fake spinner.
- **Feel premium, not cheesy.** No cartoon pumpkins, dripping blood fonts or jump scares. Spooky the way a beautiful film title sequence is spooky.
- **Have one unforgettable moment.** One thing people remember and share. Everything around it stays quiet.

Rules every direction follows

These apply whichever direction we pick.

Inspired by, never copied

- The films are **mood references only**. No character names, logos, costumes, film titles, music, screenshots or recreations of specific on-screen spell designs, in the app, the repo or the video.
- The rules require original work and the video must not contain third-party trademarks or copyrighted material. A product that reads as a fan site would put the entry at risk.
- Build every spell circle, sigil and effect ourselves, from our own shapes.

Quality floor

- **Readable:** body text contrast at least 4.5:1. Fancy display fonts only for big headings.
- **Calm by default:** every animation has a reduced-motion version. No flashing, ever.
- **Keyboard and screen reader friendly:** visible focus, real buttons, captions for anything spoken.
- **Mobile first-class:** works at 375px wide with no sideways scrolling. Judges may open it on a phone.
- **Fast:** heavy effects (WebGL, particles) must keep the page smooth on an ordinary laptop. Pause effects that are off screen.
- **Private:** fonts and assets are bundled with the site, never loaded from third-party servers. It matches our promise that nothing leaves the device.

Color has a job

In every direction, pick one color that means *you can do this* (buttons, links) and one that means *an AI made this* (model output, captions). Use them only for those jobs, so the interface teaches itself.

Screens to design

Screen	What it needs to show
Landing hero	What this is in one sentence, the summon button, the circle. Must work in five seconds.
Summoning loader	The signature moment: stages, real progress, model name and size, ready state. Reused by both apps.
Device reading	What the visitor's device can run (graphics, memory, storage) and which model size suits it.
Possessed	Camera view with the face overlay on an object, the object's speech as captions, the controls.
3 AM	Recording screen, a single dream entry, the book or archive of past nights.
States	Permission denied (camera or microphone), unsupported browser, offline, download failed.

Direction A: Sanctum

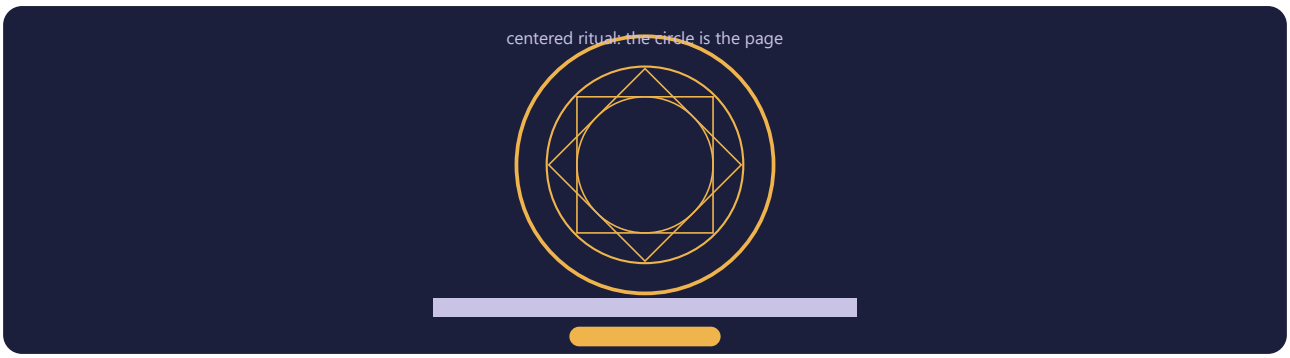
Spell geometry. Rings of golden light assemble in the air as a model arrives.

The look of modern film sorcery: a sorcerer traces glowing geometry with their hands and it hangs in the air, ring inside ring, turning slowly, throwing sparks. Calm, precise, powerful. The Halloween link is the ritual itself: we are literally summoning something into the machine.

Palette

Midnight	Spell gold	Ember	Mist	Vellum
#1B1F3B	#F0B44C	#FF7A3D	#C9C3E6	#F1EAD8

Landing layout sketch



Typefaces	Display: **Della Respira** (classical carved-stone capitals and lowercase, rare on the web). Body: **Commissioner** (calm, wide, very readable).
Layout	Centered. The spell circle sits in the middle of the first screen and the words sit under it. Content below is a single calm column.
Signature moment	Pressing *Summon* makes the circle build itself ring by ring, outer ring first. Each ring is one stage of loading (checking the device, downloading, warming up). Sparks shed off the edge as bytes arrive. When it finishes, the circle opens like a doorway into the app.
Possessed in this style	Golden geometry locks onto the object the camera sees, like a binding spell, before the face appears.
3 AM in this style	The journal is a quiet star chart; each dream is a small constellation of rune marks.
Motion	Slow rotation, spark particles, one doorway transition. Everything else still.
Watch out for	Glowing gold can look like a generic fantasy game. Keep the geometry made of our own sigils and keep the rest of the page plain.

Direction B: Hex

Chaos magic. Scarlet energy rewrites the page around you, era by era.

Wild, emotional magic that bends reality: crimson wisps of energy curling around the hands, and a world that quietly changes around you. Our twist: while a model loads, the screen travels through the decades of television, from a black-and-white 1950s picture to full modern color, as if reality were being rewritten. Halloween link: possession, hexes and cursed objects, which fits the Possessed app perfectly.

Palette

Oxblood	Scarlet	Rose mist	Smoke	Bone
#2A0F1A	#E2264F	#FF8FA3	#8E7F99	#F4ECE6

Landing layout sketch



Typefaces	Display: **Bodoni Moda** in italic (sharp, dramatic, high contrast). Body: **Hanken Grotesk**.
Layout	Split screen. Words on the left; on the right a rounded old TV screen that shows the loading story. On mobile the TV goes on top.
Signature moment	The *era shift*: the TV starts in grainy black and white with scanlines; as the download progresses it jumps through the 60s, 70s, 80s and 90s, gaining color, until it lands in the present and the model is ready. Scarlet wisps trail the cursor across the page.
Possessed in this style	Red energy seeps into the object before it wakes up. The most natural fit of all three directions.
3 AM in this style	Dreams play back on the old TV, each one in the era it felt like.
Motion	Wisps that answer the cursor, one era-shift sequence, a soft glitch on transitions.
Watch out for	Glitch effects tire people quickly and can be hard on some viewers. Keep them short, avoid flashing and give a reduced-motion version.

Direction C: Grimoire

A witch's spellbook. The interface is a book whose ink writes itself.

The most classic Halloween direction: an old spellbook by candlelight, pressed moths between the pages, wax seals, ink that writes itself. The summoning circle is drawn by an invisible quill. It is warmer and more handmade than the other two, and it photographs beautifully for the video.

Palette

Leather
#2E1F1A

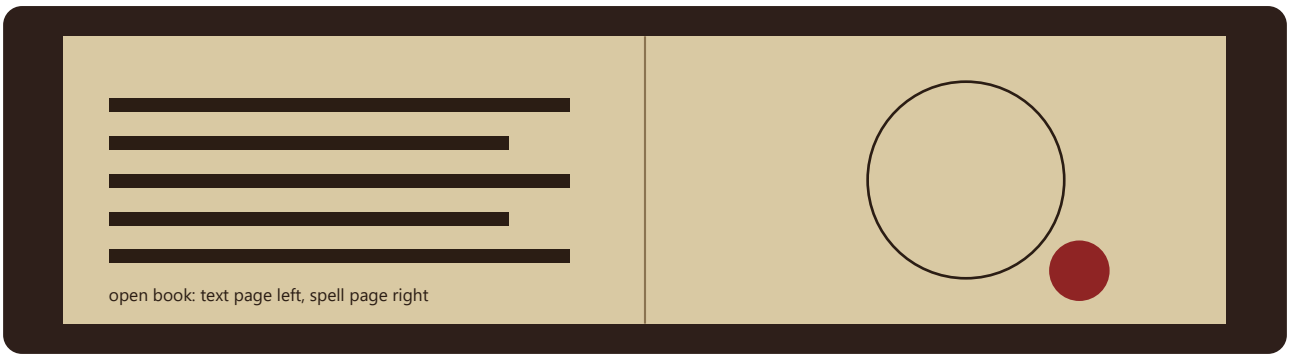
Page
#D9C9A3

Ink
#2B1D14

Wax
#8F2424

Gilt
#B8893B

Landing layout sketch



Typefaces	Display: **Pirata One** (a readable blackletter). Body: **Alegreya** (a lively book serif).
Layout	An open book on a dark leather desk: explanation on the left page, the spell circle on the right page. Scrolling turns the page.
Signature moment	The quill draws the circle stroke by stroke as the model downloads; when it finishes, a wax seal stamps the page. Buttons are wax seals.
Possessed in this style	Objects are pinned into the book like specimens, each with a handwritten label and a voice.
3 AM in this style	This is where Grimoire shines: every dream becomes a page in a private book of nights.
Motion	Ink drawing, page turns, a candle flicker. Slow and tactile.
Watch out for	Paper textures can feel heavy and old-fashioned for a tech product. Keep the type crisp and the contrast high.

How we pick

Same two screens for each direction, scored the same way.

What each mock-up includes

- The **landing hero** at desktop and phone size.
- The **summoning loader** in three states: starting, halfway, ready. A short screen recording or animated prototype is even better.
- One frame of either app in that style.

Scorecard (1 to 5 each)

Question	A: Sanctum	B: Hex	C: Grimoire
Would someone stop scrolling for the summoning moment?			
Do you understand the product in five seconds?			
Does it feel like Halloween without being cheesy?			
Does it suit both apps (loud Possessed, quiet 3 AM)?			
Can we build it well in four days?			
Will it look great in a three-minute video?			
Total			

Mixing is allowed. A common good outcome is one direction's layout with another's signature moment.

This week

Day	Goal
Sun 1 Nov	Read this brief. Collect a small moodboard (10 to 15 images) per direction.
Mon 2 to Tue 3 Nov	Make the mock-ups. Split the three directions between us; whoever finishes first takes the third.
Wed 4 Nov	Review call. Score with the scorecard, pick a direction, write its rules into the design steering doc.
Thu 5 to Sat 7 Nov	Build it: design tokens, the summoning loader as a reusable component, the landing page, shells for both apps.

Free tools and resources

Need	Free options
Mock-ups	Figma (free plan), Penpot (open source), or quick code prototypes
Fonts	Google Fonts under the Open Font License, bundled with the site through Fontsource
Animation	CSS and SVG for most things; GSAP (free) for sequences; Three.js for any 3D or particle effects
Sound	Freesound (filter by CC0 license) for chimes, whispers and ambience
Icons	Lucide (open source)
Textures	Make our own noise and grain with SVG filters, so there are no licensing questions